

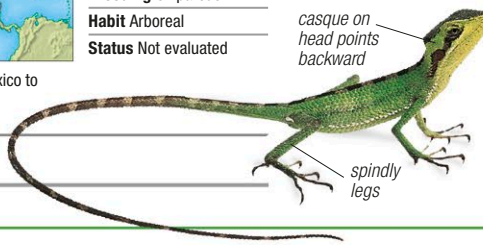
Laemantact longipes

Casque-headed iguana



Length 16–28 in (40–70 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Arboreal
Status Not evaluated

Location S. Mexico to Nicaragua



This extremely slender iguana is green with a yellow face—coloration that provides excellent camouflage among foliage. Its long legs and claws are adapted for climbing, enabling it to escape rapidly up tree trunks when threatened by predatory birds and snakes. It sits and waits for insects

to come within range, then darts out to catch them. The female lays 3–5 eggs at a time in shallow scrapes in soil or leaf litter.

Anolis sagrei

Brown anole



Length 6–8 in (15–20 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Terrestrial/Arboreal
Status Not evaluated

Location S. Mexico to Central America, Caribbean



In shape, this lizard (also known as the Cuban anole) closely resembles its relative the green anole (see opposite).

However, although it can change body color, its range is limited to brown or gray. Both sexes have an orange throat fan with a white border, which the males use during courtship displays. This anole is common on walls, climbing with the help of adhesive pads on its toes. It forages for flies and other insects, but it is less active in winter, and is hunted by larger lizards, snakes, and birds. Females lay one egg at a time throughout spring and summer. This is a short-lived lizard, with a lifespan of only 2–3 years. However, it is prolific and adaptable, and quick to colonize new areas, often ousting the native anole species.

Basiliscus plumifrons

Green basilisk



Length 23½–30 in (60–75 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Arboreal
Status Least concern

Location Central America



The green basilisk—bright green or bluish green in coloration—rests on branches and in shrubs, waiting for insects and small vertebrates before darting out to catch them. Males are very territorial; a single male may hold territory containing a harem of females with whom he mates. Females lay about 20 eggs in a season. Green basilisks can live up to 10 years in captivity.

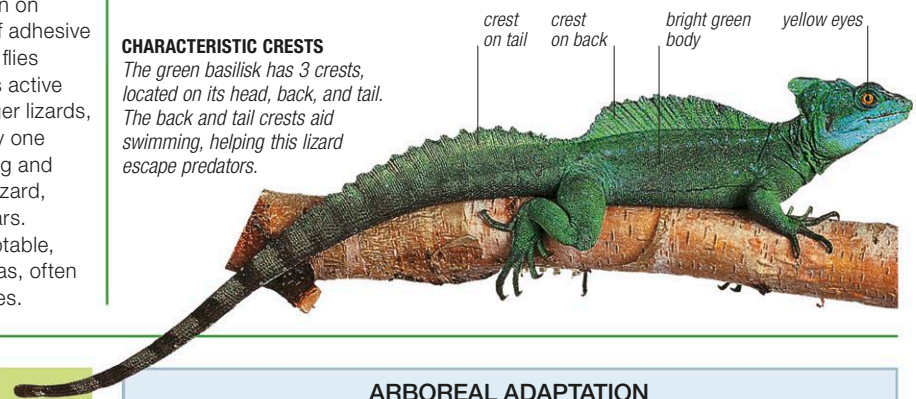
WALKING ON WATER



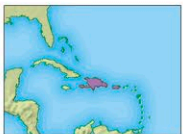
The green basilisk lives in trees bordering ponds, streams, and rivers. When threatened, it drops from its perch and dives into the water to escape. This basilisk has the unique ability to run across the surface of standing water on its hind feet, thus earning itself another common name—the Jesus Christ lizard.

CHARACTERISTIC CRESTS

The green basilisk has 3 crests, located on its head, back, and tail. The back and tail crests aid swimming, helping this lizard escape predators.

*Cyclura cornuta*

Rhinoceros iguana



Length 3¼–4 ft (1–1.2 m)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Terrestrial
Status Vulnerable

Location Caribbean



The massive gray rhinoceros iguana is characterized by several enlarged, raised scales that resemble horns on the snout of the adult. It walks ponderously, with its head held up, foraging for leaves and fruit, but can run very fast when fleeing from danger. When threatened, it may thrash its tail and bite in defense. Males are larger than females, with larger horns and crests, and are highly territorial. Females lay 2–20 eggs in burrows and guard them aggressively. All 8 species of *Cyclura* lizards are endangered due to habitat destruction and predation from introduced mammals such as pigs, dogs, rats, cats, and mongooses.

Iguana iguana

Green iguana



Length 3¼ ft (1 m), max 6½ ft (2 m)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Arboreal
Status Endangered

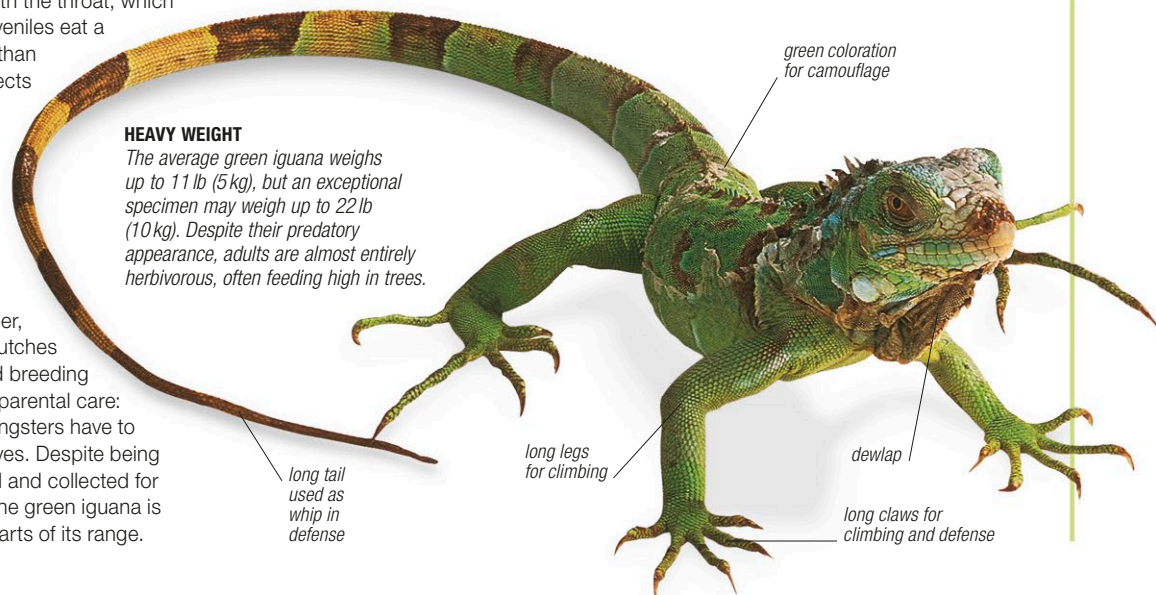
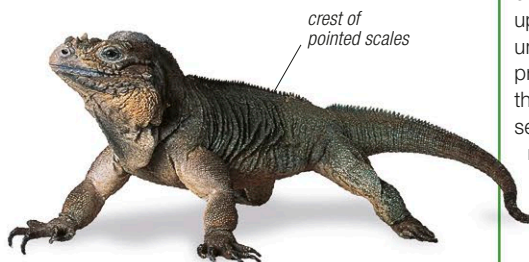
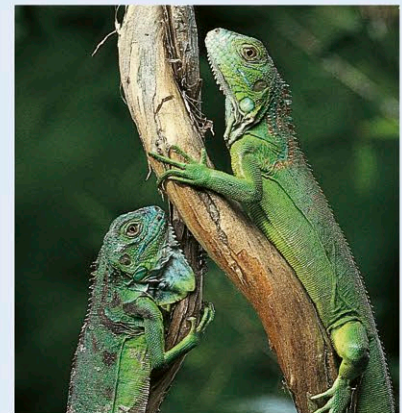
Location Central America, N. South America



The green iguana is one of the largest lizards in the Americas. Generally grayish or green—although some local populations are orange—it has stout legs, a long tail, and a crest of toothlike scales down its back. Adults also have a fleshy dewlap beneath the throat, which is large in males. Juveniles eat a wider range of food than adults, including insects as well as fruit, flowers, and leaves. Green iguanas defend themselves by lashing out with their tails and claws. Females lay up to 40 eggs in an underground chamber, producing several clutches through an extended breeding season. There is no parental care: newly hatched youngsters have to fend for themselves. Despite being hunted for food and collected for the pet trade, the green iguana is still abundant in parts of its range.

ARBOREAL ADAPTATION

The grayish or green coloration of this large iguana provides excellent camouflage in the tall forest trees in which it lives. It has long legs, and its long claws are specially adapted to aid climbing. Since this lizard usually lives beside rivers, it may drop into the water from overhanging branches to escape from predatory birds or mammals. Shown here are a male (on the left)—easily identified by the large, fleshy dewlap beneath his throat, used for display—and a female green iguana. Adult males are highly territorial.



HEAVY WEIGHT

The average green iguana weighs up to 11 lb (5 kg), but an exceptional specimen may weigh up to 22 lb (10 kg). Despite their predatory appearance, adults are almost entirely herbivorous, often feeding high in trees.